



HIGHER HEALTH

2024

POLICY ON APPEALS



Policy on Appeals

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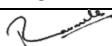
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Glossary

“Appeal” in the context of this Policy, means the formal petitioning by a learner or potential learner, to Higher Health against an administrative decision taken with respect to its Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

“Assessment” means the process used to identify, gather and interpret information against the required competencies in a qualification, part-qualification or skills programme in order to make a judgement about a learner’s achievement.

“Certificate” means a document indicating formal recognition by the QCTO of an occupational qualification, part qualification, (including legacy trades) or skills programme awarded to a successful learner.

“Curriculum” for the purposes of this Policy means requirements for learner achievement of a qualification or part-qualification in terms of knowledge, skills, and where relevant, work experience.

“e-learning” means a mode of teaching and learning that makes use of technology-mediated features.

“ Final Integrated Supervised Assessment” (FISA) means a supervised final assessment for which assessment processes, tools, and results are recorded towards the achievement of an occupational skills programme, conducted under examination conditions.

“Learner” is an inclusive term referring to anyone learning, including pupils, students, apprentices, interns, learners in learnerships, people doing training, and people learning non-formally and informally as well as people enrolled for particular qualifications or part-qualifications, and people learning in contact, distance, and self-study contexts at all levels in the system.

“National Qualifications Framework (NQF)” is a comprehensive system approved by the Minister of Higher Education and Training for the classification, registration, publication and articulation of quality assured national qualifications.

“NQF Act” means the South African National Qualifications Framework (NQF) Act No. 67 of 2008.

“NQF Level” means one of the series of levels of learning achievement arranged in ascending order from one to ten according to which the NQF is organised and to which qualification types are pegged.

“Occupational Qualifications Sub-Framework (OQSF)” means the sub-framework of qualifications developed and managed by the Quality Council for Trades and Occupations (QCTO).

“Quality Council for Trades and Occupations (QCTO)” means the Quality Council for Trades and Occupations established in terms of the NQF Act No. 67 of 2008, as amended, which is mandated to achieve the objectives of the NQF and to develop and manage the OQSF.

“Skills programme” means a programme that is occupationally based and when completed will constitute/contribute a credit towards a qualification registered on the NQF, according to Chapter 5 of the SDA.

1. Background

Higher Health is a non-profit organisation focused on the health and wellness of the youth in the post-school education and training (PSET) sector. Higher Health's model of delivering health and wellness services is to empower PSET learners to take charge of their health and wellness, through education and knowledge. Higher Health developed its e-learning Civic and Soft Skills Programme, which the QCTO accredited as a NQF Level 5 Skills Programme. All modules are inter-connected, with good citizenship underpinning the learning. The content also focuses on being good global citizens, so sustainable development goals (SDGs) feature in all the modules, and culminate in a separate module on climate change and action.

With the Civic and Soft Skills Programme, Higher Health aims to produce good national and global citizens who are empowered to take responsibility for their own health and wellbeing, who know how to assist others because of their new knowledge and skills, and who are equipped with soft skills designed for the job market.

The main target for the Civic and Soft Skills Programme are students and staff of the post-school education and training (PSET) sector in South Africa. However, other sectors have also shown an interest in this programme, and with political buy-in, may adopt it. These sectors include the youth not in education or training (NEET), and unemployed individuals currently receiving social grants. Service providers such as campus security and residence owners/managers who interact with students at PSET institutions are also good candidates for the Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to outline the principles and process for appeals related to Higher Health's Civic and Soft Skills Programme. Appeals may be related to the Civic and Soft Skills programme admissions requirements, enrolment period, or programme completion/certification.

3. Legislative and Regulatory Framework

- a. The following legislation must be considered:
 - i. Promotion of Administrative Justice Act, No, 3 of 2000
- b. This policy must be read in conjunction with Higher Health's policies on:
 - i. Admissions;

- ii. Assessment; and
- iii. Certification.

4. Scope and Application

This policy applies to all learners who have applied for entrance to Higher Health's skills programme that is accredited as such by the Quality Council on Trades and Occupations (QCTO), or are enrolled on the Civic and Soft Skills Programme.

5. Grounds for appeal

- a. Learners should note that not having data to access the e-learning platform is NOT grounds for an appeal. Higher Health is not responsible for providing learners with data.
- b. Learners may appeal if:
 - i. They are denied *access* to the Civic and Soft Skills Programme, because they do not meet the entrance requirements;
 - ii. They requested an extension to their enrolment end date, which had been denied;
 - iii. They had reached the enrolment end date, but they had not completed all the modules / not completed the 3 FISA assessments;
 - iv. They disagree with the outcome of their internal assessments or external FISA assessments results; or
 - v. Their NQF Level 5 certificate has been revoked.

6. Appeal Structures

- a. All appeals are addressed in writing, to the Director of Operations, and may be sent to info@higherhealth.ac.za
- b. Higher Health has an Appeals Committee comprising the Director of Operations (Chairperson), Director of Programmes, and the Director of Finance, to consider all appeals.
- c. All appeals will be adjudicated within thirty days of receipt.
- d. The Higher Health CEO will adjudicate any appeals referred to him by the Appeals Committee.
- e. All decisions regarding appeals relating to 5a(i) and (ii) above, and internal assessments are final.
- f. If the learner is unhappy about a decision relating to the QCTO-approved FISA assessments, or the revocation of their certificates, then the learner may submit an appeal to the Quality Council on Trades and Occupations (QCTO). The QCTO's decision is final.